Reading Language Arts · Practice Test 4

Read each passage, then answer the questions that follow. Use evidence from the texts.

Passage 1 — The Signal (science fiction)

(1) Nadia had built the radio herself, from parts she had scavenged over two years. Tonight, for the first time, it hummed to life.

(2) At first there was only static—the ordinary hiss of an empty sky. She almost switched it off. Then, beneath the noise, she heard it: a pattern. Three short tones, three long, three short. Again. And again.

(3) Her breath caught. That was no accident. Someone—or something—was sending a message.

(4) She thought of her father, who had spent his life insisting that we were not alone, and who had died before anyone believed him. She had promised to keep listening. She had nearly given up.

(5) Nadia grabbed her notebook and began to write down the pattern, her hand shaking. Whatever waited at the other end of that signal, she would answer it.

(6) Outside, the night sky stretched on, vast and silent—but to Nadia, it would never feel empty again.

1. In paragraph 1, *scavenged* most nearly means — A. bought new B. collected from discarded things C. broke apart D. painted

2. Nadia keeps listening mainly because — A. she is bored B. she promised her father C. the radio is loud D. she enjoys static

3. The repeating pattern of tones suggests — A. a broken radio B. a deliberate message C. a storm D. music

4. A theme of the story is that — A. technology is dangerous B. persistence can lead to discovery C. radios are outdated D. space is empty

5. The mood at the end of the passage is — A. hopeful and full of wonder B. angry C. bored D. fearful

6. Which line **best** shows that Nadia had almost quit? A. "she had built the radio herself" B. "She had nearly given up." C. "three short, three long, three short" D. "the night sky stretched on"

7. This passage is best described as — A. informational text B. science fiction C. a persuasive essay D. a poem

SCR 1. *(2 points)* How does the signal change the way Nadia feels about the night sky? Support your answer with **evidence from the text.**

Passage 2 — The Hidden World of Fungi (informational)

(1) When you picture a forest, you probably think of trees. But beneath your feet lies a hidden world that keeps the forest alive: fungi.

(2) Fungi are not plants or animals; they form their own kingdom. Most of a fungus is not the mushroom you see, but a web of tiny threads called mycelium, spreading through the soil.

(3) These threads connect to the roots of trees, trading nutrients for sugar. Through this network, trees can even share food and send warning signals to one another. Scientists sometimes call it the "wood wide web."

(4) Fungi also recycle. They break down fallen leaves and dead wood, returning nutrients to the soil so new plants can grow. Without fungi, forests would drown in their own waste.

(5) The next time you walk through the woods, remember: the most important part of the forest may be the part you cannot see.

8. The central idea of the passage is that — A. mushrooms are tasty B. fungi play a hidden but vital role in forests C. trees are tall D. soil is dirty

9. As used in paragraph 2, *mycelium* is — A. a mushroom cap B. a web of tiny threads in the soil C. a kind of tree D. an animal

10. Paragraph 4 is organized mainly by — A. explaining a function (recycling) and its result B. telling a story in order C. comparing two forests D. listing names

11. The author's purpose is to — A. persuade readers to eat mushrooms B. inform readers about the role of fungi C. tell a scary story D. sell soil

12. Which detail **best** supports the idea that fungi help trees? A. "fungi are not plants or animals" B. "These threads connect to the roots of trees, trading nutrients for sugar" C. "forests have trees" D. "walk through the woods"

13. From paragraph 4, the reader can infer that without fungi — A. forests would grow faster B. dead material would pile up C. trees would move D. soil would vanish

14. Which is the **best** summary? A. Forests have trees. B. Fungi form a hidden network that connects trees and recycles nutrients, making them vital to forests. C. Mushrooms grow in soil. D. Scientists like webs.

SCR 2. *(2 points)* Explain **one** way fungi help a forest. Use **evidence from the passage.**

Paired Set — Bike Lanes

Text A — "Build More Bike Lanes" (argument)

Cities should build more protected bike lanes. They make streets safer for everyone, cut traffic, and reduce pollution. When people feel safe riding, more of them leave their cars at home.

Text B — "By the Numbers"

A recent study found that streets with protected bike lanes had 40% fewer injuries for all road users. Cities that added bike lanes also saw a rise in local business as more people stopped to shop.

15. The claim in Text A is that — A. bikes are expensive B. cities should build more protected bike lanes C. cars are fast D. streets are wide

16. Text B mainly provides — A. a personal story B. data that supports bike lanes C. an opinion against bikes D. a poem

17. Together, the texts suggest that bike lanes — A. are useless B. benefit safety and communities C. only help cyclists D. cause traffic

18. Which specific evidence appears in Text B but **not** in Text A? A. bike lanes are safer B. the "40% fewer injuries" statistic C. cities have streets D. people ride bikes

19. Text A's main purpose is to — A. inform with statistics B. argue for building bike lanes C. entertain D. give directions

20. Text B strengthens Text A's argument mainly by — A. adding a story B. providing facts and numbers as evidence C. disagreeing with it D. using rhyme

Revising — "A Chess Club"

(1) Our school should start a chess club. (2) Chess teaches planning. (3) It helps students think ahead. (4) Anyone can learn. (5) We would meet once a week. (6) A chess club would be a great addition to our school.

21. Which sentence could **best** be added after sentence 3 to develop it with a detail? A. "Chess is old." B. "For example, players must think several moves ahead to win." C. "I like games." D. "Clubs meet."

22. Which transition would **best** begin sentence 4? A. However, B. In addition, C. Because D. Finally,

23. What is the **best** way to combine sentences 2 and 3? A. Chess teaches planning, it helps think ahead. B. Chess teaches planning and helps students think ahead. C. Planning and thinking, chess. D. Chess, planning, thinking ahead.

24. Which sentence **best** states the writer's main idea (thesis)? A. Sentence 1 B. Sentence 2 C. Sentence 4 D. Sentence 5

Editing — "The Concert"

(1) Last night, my sister and me went to a concert. (2) The band were amazing. (3) We clapped until our hands hurt. (4) It was the best night of my hole life.

25. What change should be made in sentence 1? A. Change "me" to "I" B. Change "went" to "gone" C. Change "night" to "nite" D. No change

26. What change should be made in sentence 2? A. Change "were" to "was" B. Change "band" to "bands" C. Change "amazing" to "amazed" D. No change

27. What change should be made in sentence 3? A. Change "clapped" to "clap" B. Change "our" to "are" C. Change "hands" to "hand" D. No change

28. What change should be made in sentence 4? A. Change "hole" to "whole" B. Change "best" to "bestest" C. Change "night" to "Night" D. No change

Extended Constructed Response (ECR) — *(10 points)*

Using **"The Hidden World of Fungi,"** write a multi-paragraph **informational essay** that explains **why fungi are important to forests.** Use evidence from the passage. Organize your essay with an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion, and use correct grammar and spelling.

Answers and full explanations for this test are in Part 3 · Answer Keys & Explanations.